

Quake 4 (Q4), which was only recently released, uses the *Doom 3* engine to deliver perhaps the best graphics seen in a game yet! Q4 continues where the story of *Quake II* left off—mopping up what’s left after the destruction you caused in *Quake II*.

You play Matthew Kane, and are assigned to Rhino Squad. The game puts you on an alien planet and you are assigned tasks in succession. These tasks vary from destroying all enemies, protecting a fellow marine, leading a medic to a downed comrade, or just bypassing obstacles that are preventing your squad from advancing.

At least in *Quake 4* you have help from some good AI allies, and aren’t expected to destroy the alien race all by yourself. The game really showcases the *Doom 3* engine, and everything looks marvelous. There are a few sequences, such as when an unsuspecting marine is suddenly killed before your eyes by a horrific-looking alien, that take you back to the *Doom 3* scariness, but overall, it’s still pretty much a great-looking shoot ‘em up.

The multiplayer mode is pretty much Q3A with much, much better graphics. Apart from the breathtaking models and textures, there’s nothing new here.

A game that requires a really high-end system indeed, Q4 is better suited for those who want a multiplayer game to show off their dual-GPU gaming rigs. For sheer multiplayer fun, Q3A will suffice.

Serious Sam II

This is a follow up of the first game, *Serious Sam: The First Encounter* (SS:TFE). Back then, SS:TFE was something new. It had plenty of humour, no story whatsoever, no physics, and was blatantly absurd. The game developed fans by the hordes back then mainly because it was a novel idea. The game intended to make no sense at all, and did this with aplomb. There was no particular reason given as to why you were on an alien planet killing thousands of monsters, and the weapons were as deadly as they were funny.